

7.1 Upcoming Technologies

First, we will take a look at the new emerging technologies that will impact our future in the digital entertainment arena.

As mentioned earlier, the digital audio segment has two competitors on the horizon; DVD-Audio and SACD. These two are the only formats that are being currently pushed in the market. Since we have already talked at length about both, we will shift our focus to the digital video segment where the action is a wee bit more exciting.

Digital video is the mainstay of home entertainment since people like watching movies. It is in our nature to visualise and this is where video steps in.

Starting with the VHS tape, we have come a long way to the DVD that is the new face of entertainment. However, this format will soon be history if some companies have their way.

A DVD provides more space for storage than any other removable media that is currently available to consumers. With the advent of DVD, you can not only see movies with more clarity, but also other 'featurettes' such as "Behind The Scenes" and "Director's Views" that are not available on a VCD. Such additions make buying a DVD more appealing to the consumer. This is clearly because of the 8.5 GB space that is available on a DVD. Now multiply this amount of data by five and you will get the idea on the future of digital storage.

Blu-Ray is a technology that is being pushed by Sony and other major companies including Apple, Dell, Hitachi, HP, JVC, LG, Mitsubishi, Panasonic, Pioneer, Philips, Samsung, Sharp, Sony, TDK and Thomson.

The Blu-ray format was developed to enable recording, rewriting and playback of high-definition video (HD), as well as